Chase Gobble

Creative Director | Founding Designer | Design Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Block-shaped creative leader with 19+ years threading together brand design, product design, visual design, business strategy, and design engineering into unified systems for technology companies from founding stage through IPO. I'm a designer with deep, demonstrated skill across five distinct disciplines (see below), each reinforcing the others. Currently serving as an embedded creative director helping startups bootstrap AI processes and build AI product offerings, and actively seeking an in-house founding designer or creative leadership role where I can commit to one company's mission, compound results over time, and build something with big ambitions. All workflows are AI-native, operating daily with Claude Code, Cursor, and Figma.

CORE COMPETENCIES

brand design — creative direction, identity systems, visual brand frameworks, art direction, typography, investor narrative and pitch design
product design — experience architecture, information architecture, design systems, component libraries, web strategy, prototyping
business strategy — market positioning, go-to-market communications, okr-aligned operations, brief-led governance, executive communications
design engineering — front-end development (react, next.js, tailwind css, git), ai-native workflows (claude code, cursor, figma make, lovable), design-to-code production
leadership — cross-functional team building and mentorship, creative operations at scale, video production and motion design, studio critique culture

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RECENT IMPACT

Supported +$100M in client funding rounds through brand systems and investor narrative design in a single calendar year

Increased site conversion by 3X (enterprise) and up to 6X (select startups) through narrative-led web architecture

Improved creative project delivery timelines by 4X through AI-assisted workflows and process design

Shipped 20+ integrated campaigns across global regions and cross-product portfolios

Consulted with multiple AI startups on bootstrapping AI into their design and product design/build operations

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EXPERIENCE

Clerestory Group

Founding Partner and Creative Director | 2020 to Present

Co-founded a design cooperative with two longtime collaborators, built on a flat-fee sprint model that translates business goals into focused, measurable creative projects. I partner directly with seed-to-growth-stage AI and technology companies as an embedded creative director building brand systems, product experiences, and investor narratives from the ground up while helping founders integrate AI capabilities into their design operations and product offerings.

- Serve as founding designer and distributed creative director for AI product startups, owning brand identity, product design, web architecture, and go-to-market from day one
- Consult with founders on integrating AI into their product development and design workflows, building operational AI fluency from the inside out
- Curated a new workflow system for handling the ever-changing front of product building; meant as a replacement for Agile, this framework puts ultimate importance on the design and engineering cohesiveness and uses robust design systems to create highly capable AI-assisted product building that moves fast and removes the handoff bottleneck
- Build dynamic identity systems and visual brand frameworks that scale from pitch deck through product-market fit
- Design investor narratives, pitch materials, and market positioning that have supported over $100M in combined client funding rounds
- Architect web experiences using narrative-led information architecture, increasing site conversion by up to 6X for select startup clients
- Operate with AI-native workflows like Claude Code for design system scaffolding and code generation, Cursor for rapid front-end prototyping, Figma for iterative visual design
- Synthesize business strategy, user experience, and market positioning into unified design systems that serve customers, investors, and internal teams

Select projects include Finfuego (AI product, brand system, and investor narrative), Stanford University Shorenstein APARC (campaign system and design-led launch engine), nSight (integrated event creative and keynote story), Coraa AI (AI product brand system, market launch, and investor narrative), and Young Scientist Academy (pro bono nonprofit rebrand and fundraising enablement).

nCino

Global Creative Director, Head of Creative | 2018 to 2025

Built, led, and scaled a global creative organization of 15 team members across three continents, spanning design, video and motion, web, SEO, and copy. Established a brief-led operating system tied to marketing OKRs that brought sprint discipline, critique cadence, and governance to all creative production.

- Directed all visual design, brand production, and creative strategy for a publicly traded fintech company through IPO and sustained growth
- Built and maintained a design system and brand templating library that improved template adoption by 22% and reduced production bottlenecks across distributed teams
- Led, produced, and directed a remote-first IPO roadshow video package during a volatile market period, unifying the company narrative for investor, customer, and internal audiences
- Partnered with Product and Engineering on cross-functional product strategy, contributing design direction to major platform launches
- Introduced AI-assisted production workflows that improved creative project delivery timelines by 4X while maintaining craft standards
- Led a comprehensive global web overhaul, re-architecting from technical catalog to narrative-driven brand experience, resulting in 3X site conversion increase
- Managed 30% year-over-year growth in creative project volume while maintaining a flat headcount through process optimization and early AI tooling

W2O Group

Associate Creative Director | 2015 to 2018

Elevated from contract designer to in-house role and promoted to Associate Creative Director. Partnered with biotech startups and venture capital firms to build corporate identities, drug sub-brands, and investor-facing communications.

- Led cross-functional teams of designers, scientists, founders, and communications specialists to deliver brand identities, pitch decks, annual reports, and digital assets for healthcare and life sciences companies
- Served clients including Agios, Moma Therapeutics, Thrive, Third Rock Ventures, Bluebird Bio, and Maze Therapeutics
- Translated complex scientific and technical subject matter into clear, high-impact brand narratives for investor engagement, product launches, and IPO milestones
- Developed strategic visual positioning that strengthened market narratives for early-stage biotech ventures through funding rounds and regulatory milestones

Amazon Web Services

Designer | 2013 to 2015

Designed management console experiences for Amazon Web Services, contributing to service-level UI redesigns and usability improvements during the platform's push toward mobile-aware enterprise interfaces.

- Refined early console interface patterns for clarity, density, and flow across cloud management tools used by millions of developers and engineering teams
- Contributed to the Elastic Beanstalk console redesign and related service interface improvements
- Transitioned from UI design into visual design production, working across a broad range of brand and marketing projects for the AWS ecosystem

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EDUCATION

The New School, Parsons School of Design

MFA in Photography

The New School, Parsons School of Design

BBA in Strategic Design and Management

The New School, Lang College of Liberal Arts

BA in Philosophy

TOOLS AND TECHNOLOGIES

Design and Prototyping

Figma, Adobe Creative Suite, After Effects

AI and Development

Claude Code, Cursor, Figma Make, Lovable, React, Next.js, Tailwind CSS, Git, HTML/CSS, Warp

Production and Operations

Video scripting and production management, brief-led sprint systems, OKR alignment, design governance frameworks